

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: The 1972-73 economic crisis

TWIN MONSOON FAILURES + 1973 OIL SHOCK -> deepening scarcity

PRICE RISE -> about 22 per cent over 1972-73

EFFECT -> inflation, unemployment, food scarcity erode Indira Gandhi's popularity

TIMING -> follows directly on the 1971 Garibi Hatao landslide

MUST REMEMBER: The 1973-74 inflation and oil shock preceded Gujarat's Nav Nirman movement, the Bihar movement and May 1974 railway strike; the Allahabad High Court judgment came on 12 June 1975, the Emergency was proclaimed on 25 June and publicly announced on 26 June, constitutional and coercive instruments followed, elections were called in January 1977 and the Emergency ended on 21 March 1977 before the 44th Amendment of 1978.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Nav Nirman and the Bihar movement, 1974

NAV NIRMAN -> Gujarat, JANUARY 1974; students protest prices and corruption

BIHAR MOVEMENT -> MARCH 1974; JP takes leadership

JP'S CALL -> "Total Revolution" / Sampoorna Kranti

SPREAD -> student unrest becomes a nationwide anti-government movement

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: The railway strike, May 1974

ALL-INDIA RAILWAY STRIKE -> MAY 1974, lasting 22 days

DIRECT CHALLENGE -> to the government's authority

ADDED DIMENSION -> economic disruption layered onto the political crisis

CONTEXT -> deepens the crisis JP's movement was already building on

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: The Allahabad High Court judgment, 12 June 1975

PETITIONER -> Raj Narain

JUDGE -> Justice Jagmohanlal Sinha, Allahabad High Court

DATE -> 12 JUNE 1975

RULING -> sets aside Indira Gandhi's 1971 election on electoral malpractice

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: The Supreme Court's conditional stay, 24 June 1975

COURT -> Supreme Court, Justice V.R. Krishna Iyer

DATE -> 24 JUNE 1975

RULING -> CONDITIONAL stay of the Allahabad verdict

EFFECT -> Indira Gandhi remains Prime Minister while the appeal is pending

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: The proclamation: dated 25 June, announced 26 June

JP'S DELHI RALLY -> 25 JUNE 1975; calls for civil disobedience

PROCLAMATION -> Article 352, DATED 25 JUNE 1975

PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT -> only on 26 JUNE 1975

TRAP -> the two dates must never be collapsed into one

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Instruments of the Emergency: MISA, censorship, 42nd Amendment

DETENTIONS -> under MISA; over 100,000 held without trial, ~19 months

PRESS -> censorship imposed

CONSTITUTIONAL CHANGE -> 42nd Amendment, 1976; expands central/executive power

AGENDA -> Twenty-Point Programme, 1 July 1975

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Sanjay Gandhi's extra-constitutional power and its excesses

POSITION -> no formal office; extra-constitutional power centre

PROGRAMME -> his own four-point programme, 1976

EXCESSES -> compulsory sterilisation drives

EXCESSES -> slum-demolition drives

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: 1977: the electoral reversal

ELECTIONS CALLED -> January 1977

ELECTIONS HELD -> March 1977

RESULT -> Congress and Sanjay Gandhi defeated

MEANING -> a verdict FOR civil liberties; ends the Emergency

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: What held and what failed

HELD -> the electoral machinery itself; free verdict delivered in 1977

FAILED -> Parliament; failed to check the executive

FAILED -> the ruling party; offered no internal restraint

FAILED -> judiciary's detention jurisprudence, in the MISA cases

CLOSE DISTINCTION: The Allahabad High Court, not the Supreme Court, initially invalidated Indira Gandhi's election; proclamation and public announcement dates must remain distinct; and student/middle-class leadership did not mean uniform incorporation of industrial workers, peasants, Dalits or every region.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: The JP movement's social base

BASE -> students, middle class, traders, intelligentsia

NOT THE BASE -> rural poor or the organised urban working class

STRENGTH -> moral authority sufficient to destabilise the government

LIMITATION -> no base broad enough to govern after 1977

EVIDENCE LIMIT: The proclamation, MISA/detention records, press censorship orders, 38th/39th/42nd Amendments, sterilisation and clearance evidence, Shah Commission findings and the 1977 verdict must be cross-read without reducing the Emergency to either one leader's will or a socially uniform resistance.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Fifty years of the Emergency, 2025

EVENT -> Union Cabinet resolution, 25 JUNE 2025

CONTENT -> commemorates fifty years since the Emergency

FRAMING -> honours resistance; reaffirms constitutional democracy

SOURCE -> PIB, PRID 2139543 (no public URL recorded by the owner)